The AIE Network

// AI PRIMER · 60 MINUTES

Selling with AI

Claude gives you superpowers, but only if you set it up. Here's how, and what to do this week.

Mark R. Hinkle

Publisher, The AIE Network · CEO, Peripety Labs

NOVEMBER 4, 2026

I've been on both sides of this table

- Thirty years in enterprise tech: the dot-com run, open source, cloud, now AI
- Ran marketing at cloud.com through the Citrix acquisition, ran the Node.js Foundation, co-founded TriggerMesh
- Today I run Peripety Labs and publish The AIE Network, seven newsletters and the All Things AI conference
- I still sell every day: sponsorships, tickets, consulting. Same quota pressure you have, smaller team



MARK R. HINKLE

The AI drafts. You send.

Everything today hangs off that sentence. Research, email, call prep, follow-up, proposals. The assistant does the reading and the first draft. Your name goes on it, so you read it and you hit send.

Here's how we'll spend the time

CLOCK	BLOCK	WHAT	MIN	FORMAT
0:00 – 0:04	OPENING	Opening	4	Talk
0:04 – 0:08	BLOCK 1	Where AI fits in a seller's week	4	Talk
0:08 – 0:16	BLOCK 2	Give Claude your tools	8	Talk
0:16 – 0:19	BLOCK 3	Set it up once, the three files	3	Talk
0:19 – 0:24	BLOCK 4	Teach it once with skills	5	Talk
0:24 – 0:30	BLOCK 5	Research an account in ten minutes	6	Live demo
0:30 – 0:38	BLOCK 6	Outreach with Prospector	8	Talk
0:38 – 0:41	BLOCK 7	Outreach that sounds like you	3	Talk
0:41 – 0:45	BLOCK 8	Before, during and after the call	4	Talk
0:45 – 0:48	BLOCK 9	The rules that keep you employed	3	Talk
0:48 – 0:50	BLOCK 10	Your first week	2	Talk
0:50 – 0:58	BLOCK 11	Put it all together, Chatterbuilt Mail	8	Live demo
0:58 – 1:00	CLOSE	Close	2	Talk

About half of a seller's week isn't selling.

It's reading, looking things up, writing the same email a slightly different way, and typing into HubSpot or Salesforce. That half is what we're going after today.

What it's good at today, and what it isn't

GOOD AT

Reading and summarizing

A 10-K, forty job postings, a two-hour transcript. Faster than you, and it doesn't get tired. It does miss things, which is why the sources matter.

GOOD AT

First drafts and rehearsal

Email, follow-ups, proposals, and playing the skeptical buyer so you can practice.

NOT YET

Knowing your buyer

It has never met them. It doesn't know what was said at the last QBR unless you tell it.

NOT YET

Judgment and relationships

When to push, when to walk, who actually signs. That's still you, and it's the paid part.

You probably already own the tools

- A general assistant: Claude, ChatGPT or Gemini. One is plenty. Use the paid company seat
- A meeting recorder: Zoom's AI Companion or a recorder like Fireflies, or the one built into your video calls
- Your CRM's assistant: HubSpot or Salesforce ships one now. It's fine for notes and summaries
- Enrichment and sequencing: Apollo for the lists and sends. Keep the AI in the drafting seat

02

Give Claude your tools

Settings first. Connections before prompts.

Claude gives you superpowers. Only if you set it up.

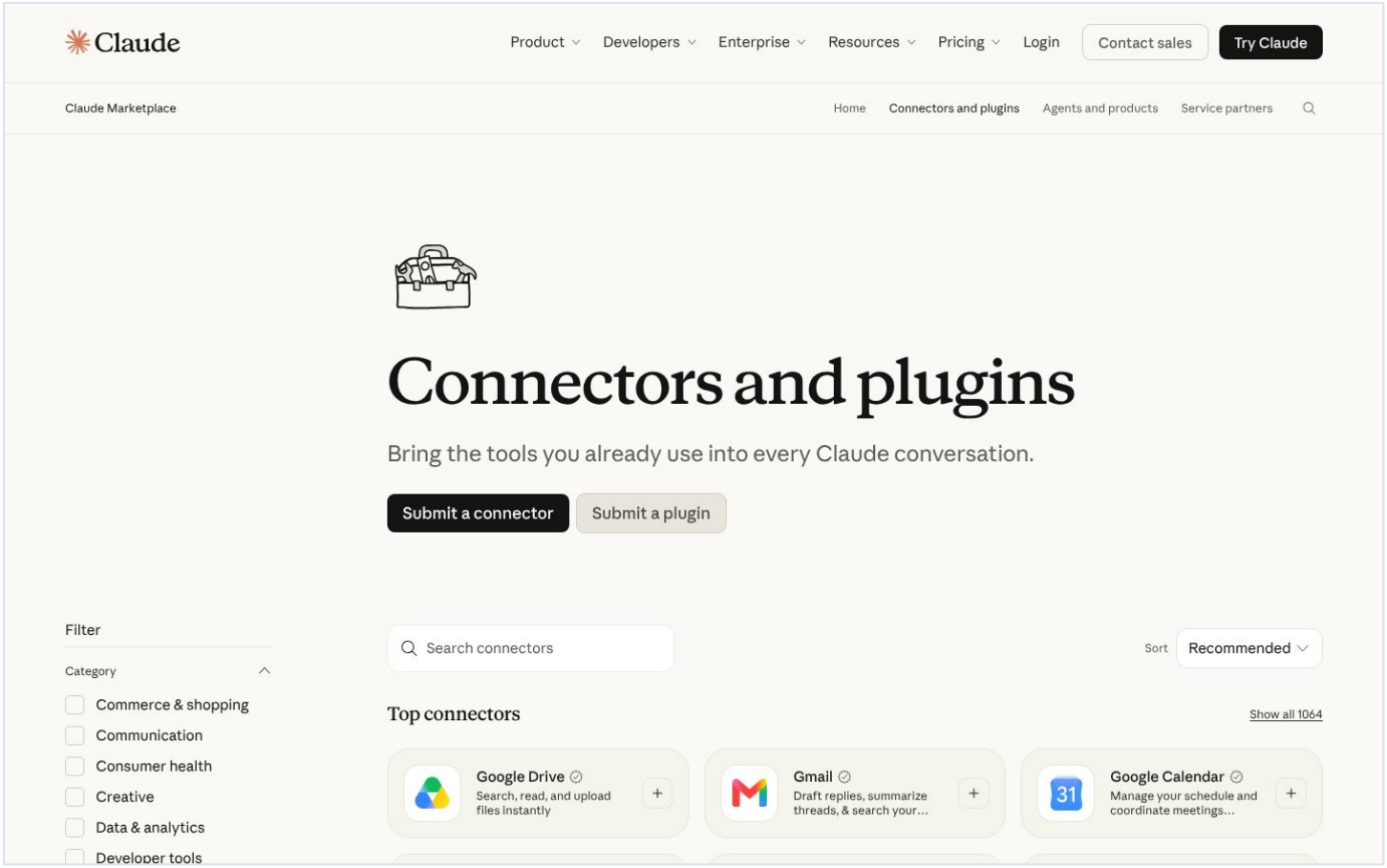
Out of the box it knows the internet. It doesn't know your accounts, your calendar or your pipeline.

Start in Settings, not in the chat box

Connectors	**Plug in your tools**	Gmail, calendar, CRM, Slack. Claude reads and drafts inside them.
Skills	**Teach it how you work**	Your voice, your ICP, your call prep. Loaded only when needed.
Projects	**Keep the three files handy**	Every chat in the project starts with them already read.
Chrome	**Let it use the browser**	For the sites that have no connector. You approve what happens.

Turn on the connectors Claude already ships

- Gmail, Google Calendar and Drive, or Microsoft 365 for Outlook and Teams
- HubSpot, Slack, Notion and Zoom, each a one-click connect
- Over a thousand more in the directory. Start with five



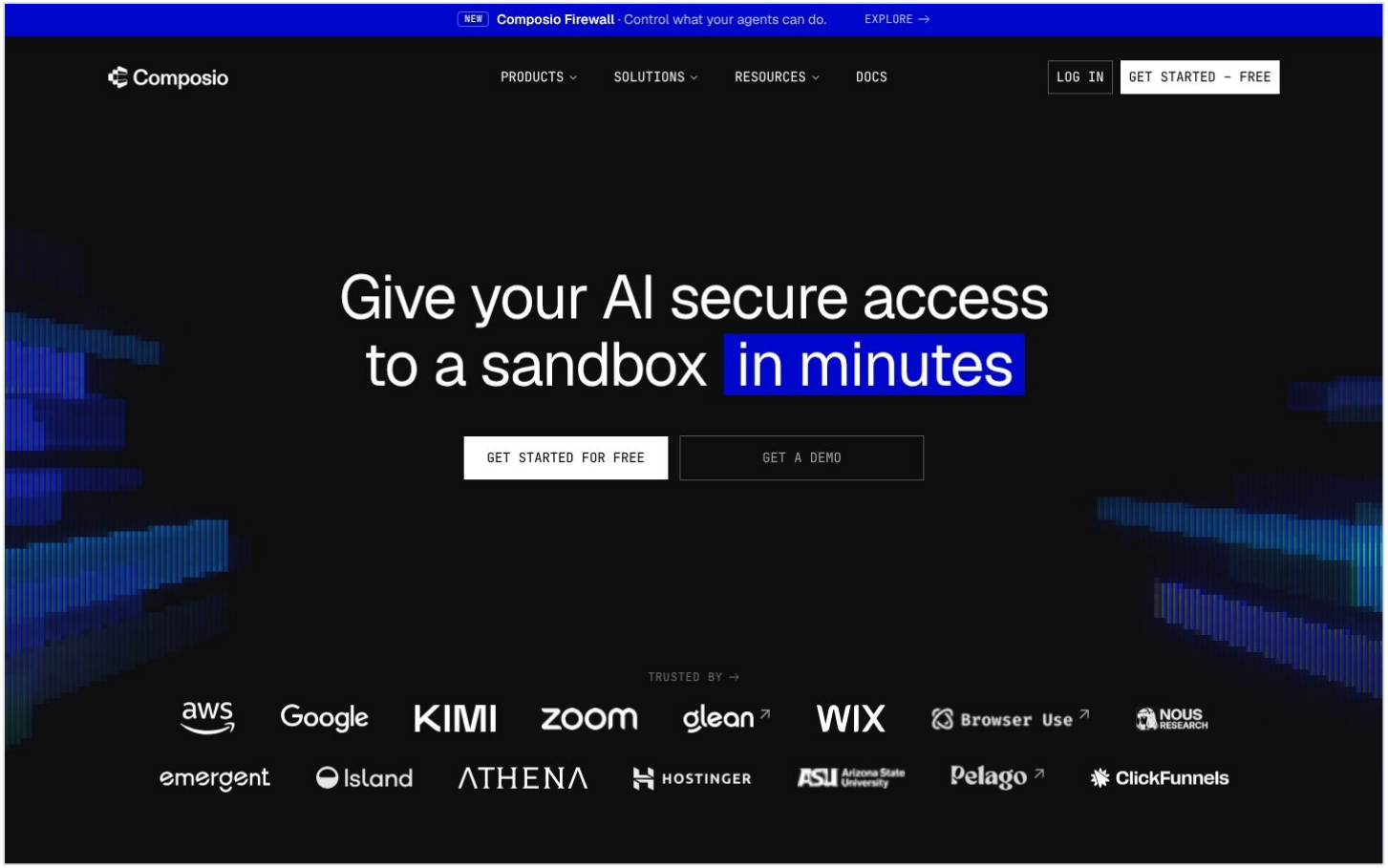
CLAUDE'S CONNECTORS DIRECTORY, CLAUDE.COM. NOVEMBER 2026

Connect the tools you already sell with

CRM	**HubSpot or Salesforce**	Account history before every call, notes after it.
Email and calendar	**Gmail, Outlook**	Read the thread, draft the reply, find the meeting.
Prospecting	**Apollo**	Lists, enrichment and sequences, from inside the chat.
Calls and team	**Zoom, Fireflies, Slack**	Transcripts in, recaps out, deal channels kept current.

Or do what I do: Composio, everything in one place

- One connection gives Claude access to over 1,500 tools
- Salesforce, HubSpot, Gmail, LinkedIn and the long tail
- Check with IT before connecting company systems



COMPOSIO, COMPOSIO.DEV. NOVEMBER 2026

Three files your assistant reads before every task

VOICE

How you actually write

Five emails you were proud of. Three you'd never send. A line about how you talk to [buyer].

ICP

Who buys, who doesn't

Company size, titles, the trigger events that make them call, and what disqualifies a lead on sight.

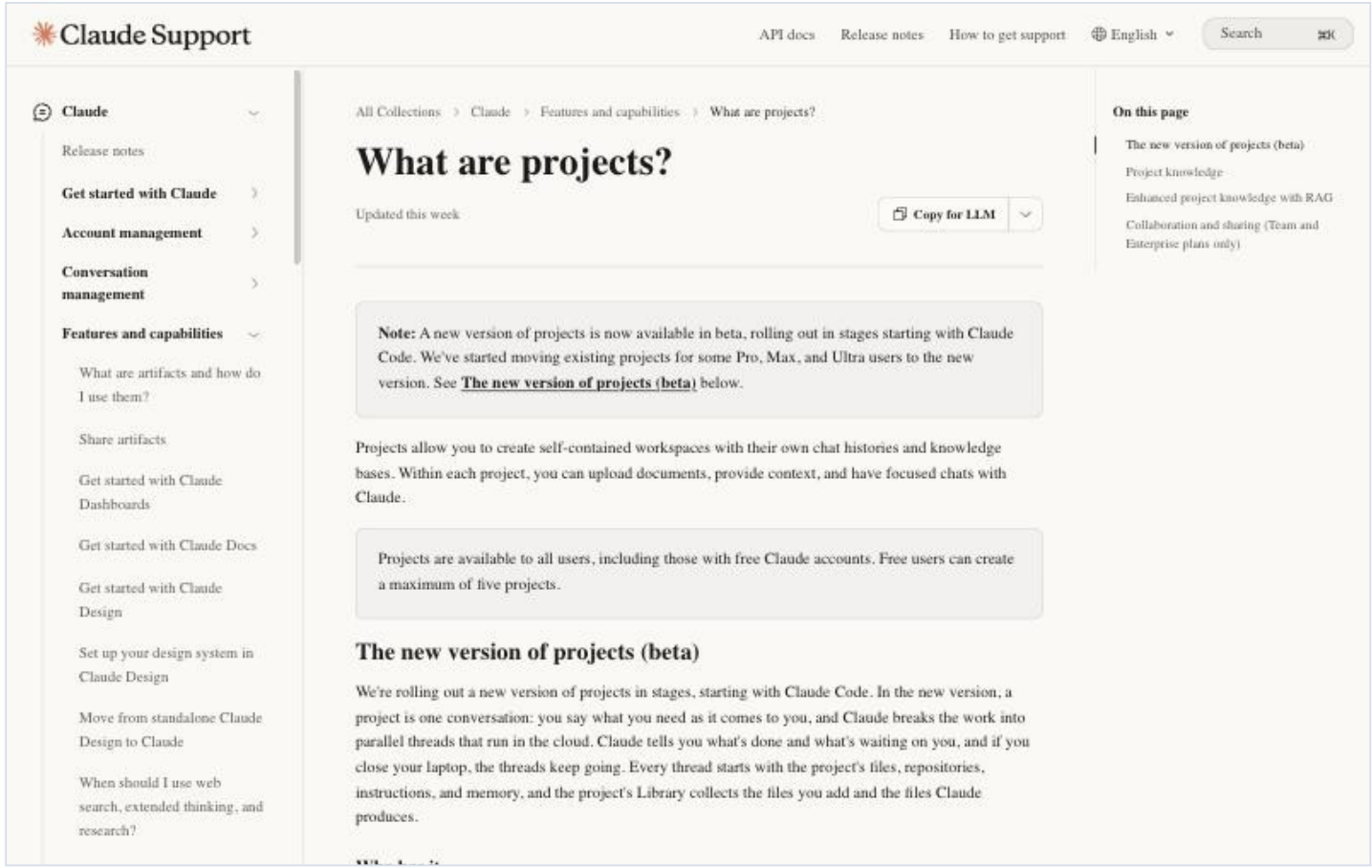
PRODUCT

[product] in the buyer's words

What it does, the three problems it fixes, proof you can name, and what you're not allowed to promise.

Put them where the assistant reads them every time

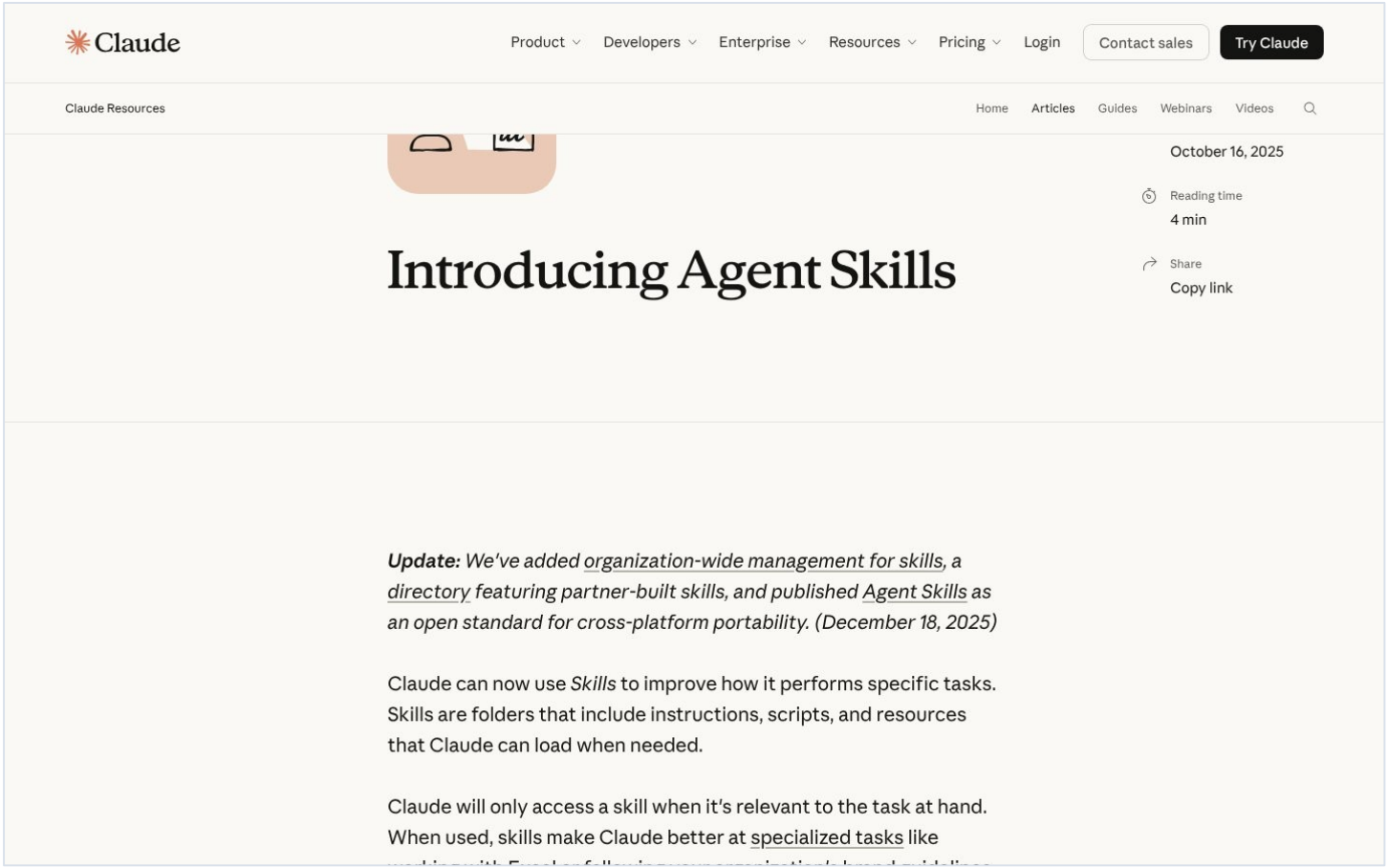
- ChatGPT calls it a Project, Claude calls it a Project, Gemini calls it a Gem
- Upload the three files once. Every new chat in that folder starts with them loaded
- Use the company seat, so the files stay inside your company's account



CLAUDE PROJECTS, WHERE THE THREE FILES LIVE. NOVEMBER 2026

Skills are how you stop explaining yourself

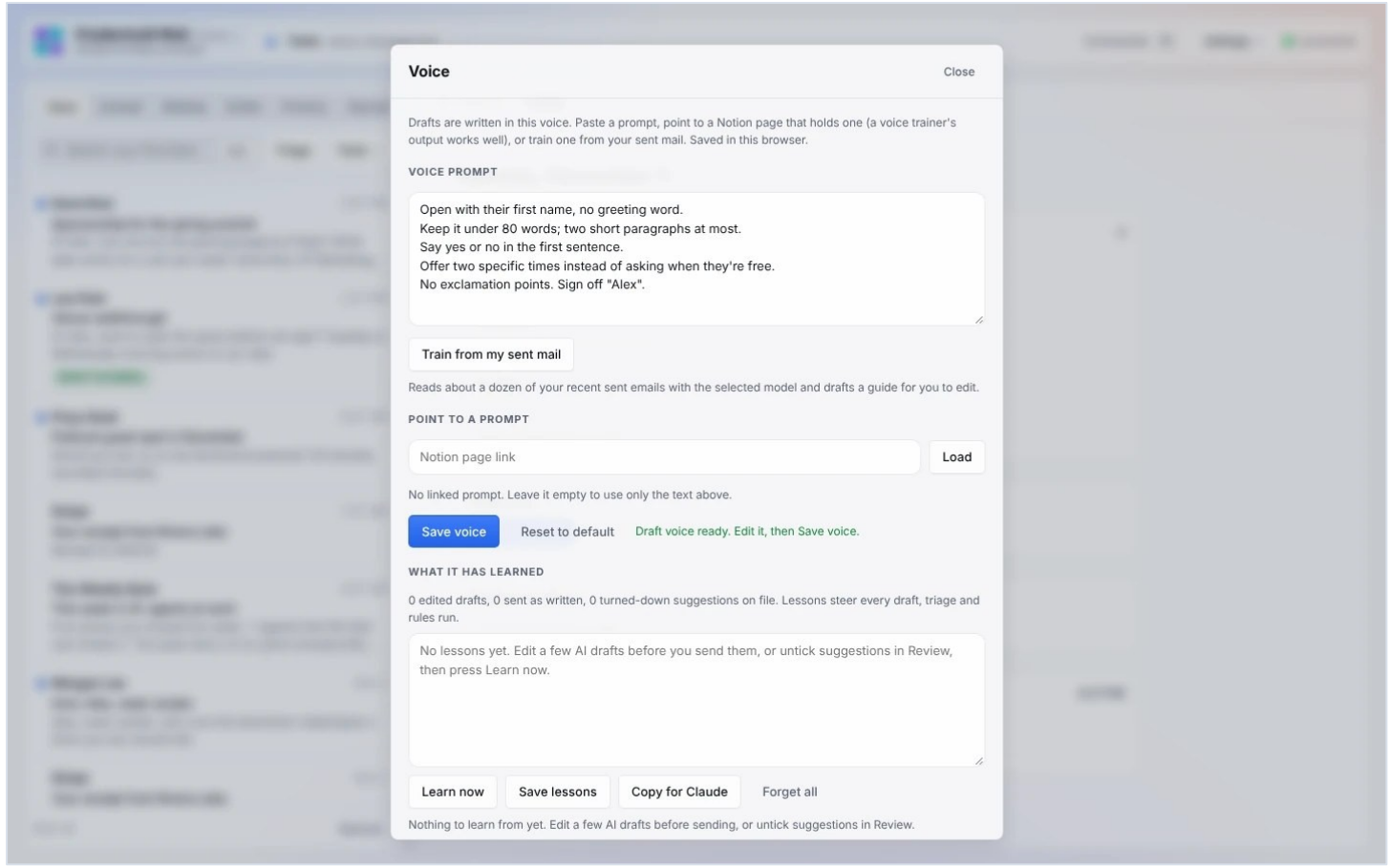
- A folder of instructions Claude loads only when the task needs it
- Write it once. It works in every chat, every project
- Turn them on in Settings, or ask Claude to write one for you



INTRODUCING AGENT SKILLS, CLAUDE.COM. NOVEMBER 2026

Train it on your own sent mail

- The email voice profile skill reads your recent sent email
- It writes a one-page guide: tone, length, openers, words you never use
- Every draft after that sounds like you, not a polite robot



TRAINING A VOICE FROM SENT MAIL, CHATTERBUILT MAIL. MADE-UP DATA. NOVEMBER 2026

Three skills every seller should build first

01

My voice

Your best emails, the words you'd never use, how you handle a no.

02

Account brief

The research steps, the sources, the UNVERIFIED rule.

03

Call follow-up

Summary, email, CRM notes and tasks, in your team's headings.

05

Research an account in ten minutes

The brief you'd want before any first call, with links, from a company name.

Collect, brief, verify, then one sentence on why now

01

Collect

Their site, latest news, open job postings, the annual report if public, and the LinkedIn pages for your two or three contacts.

02

Brief

One prompt, with your ICP and product files loaded, produces the page.

03

Verify

Every claim gets a link. No link, no claim. Fix the two things it got wrong.

04

Why now

One line you could say out loud: the trigger, the likely pain, your angle.

The account brief prompt

TYPE THIS, VERBATIM

```
Build a one-page account brief on [Company]. Use my ICP and product files.
Sources attached: [paste or link site, news, job posts, filings, contact profiles].

Sections: what they do and how they make money; what changed in the last six months;
what they're hiring for and what that says; who my contacts are and what they care about;
where [product] plausibly fits, in their words; three discovery questions; one "why now" sentence.
Cite a source for every factual claim. If you can't source it, mark it UNVERIFIED.
```

Watch me do it on a real target account.

Ten minutes on the clock. Collect, run the prompt, click two links, write the "why now" sentence.

Four things it gets wrong, and how you catch them

- Stale people. Titles change. Check the two contacts on LinkedIn before you mention them
- Look-alike companies. Two firms with similar names get blended. Confirm the domain
- Invented numbers and quotes. If you can't click to it, it didn't happen
- Trigger events that are old news. Check the date on anything it calls recent

06

Outreach that sounds like you

Prospector finds who to talk to and why now. You send.

Prospector: who to talk to, and why now

icp	**Define who fits**	The ideal customer profile and a fit-times-timing score.
signals	**Rank this week's reasons**	Job posts, press, intent and Sales Navigator alerts, ranked.
qualify	**Research with sources**	Sourced facts on each account. No fabrication.
draft	**Write in your voice**	Drafts go into a queue. Nothing is sent.
queue	**You approve**	What's waiting, today's caps, mark it sent or drop it.

The guardrails are in the code, not a promise

01

It never sends

Every draft waits in the approval queue for you.

02

LinkedIn stays yours

Clicks that connect, post or message are blocked outright.

03

Paced and capped

Quiet hours, daily caps, a suppression list.

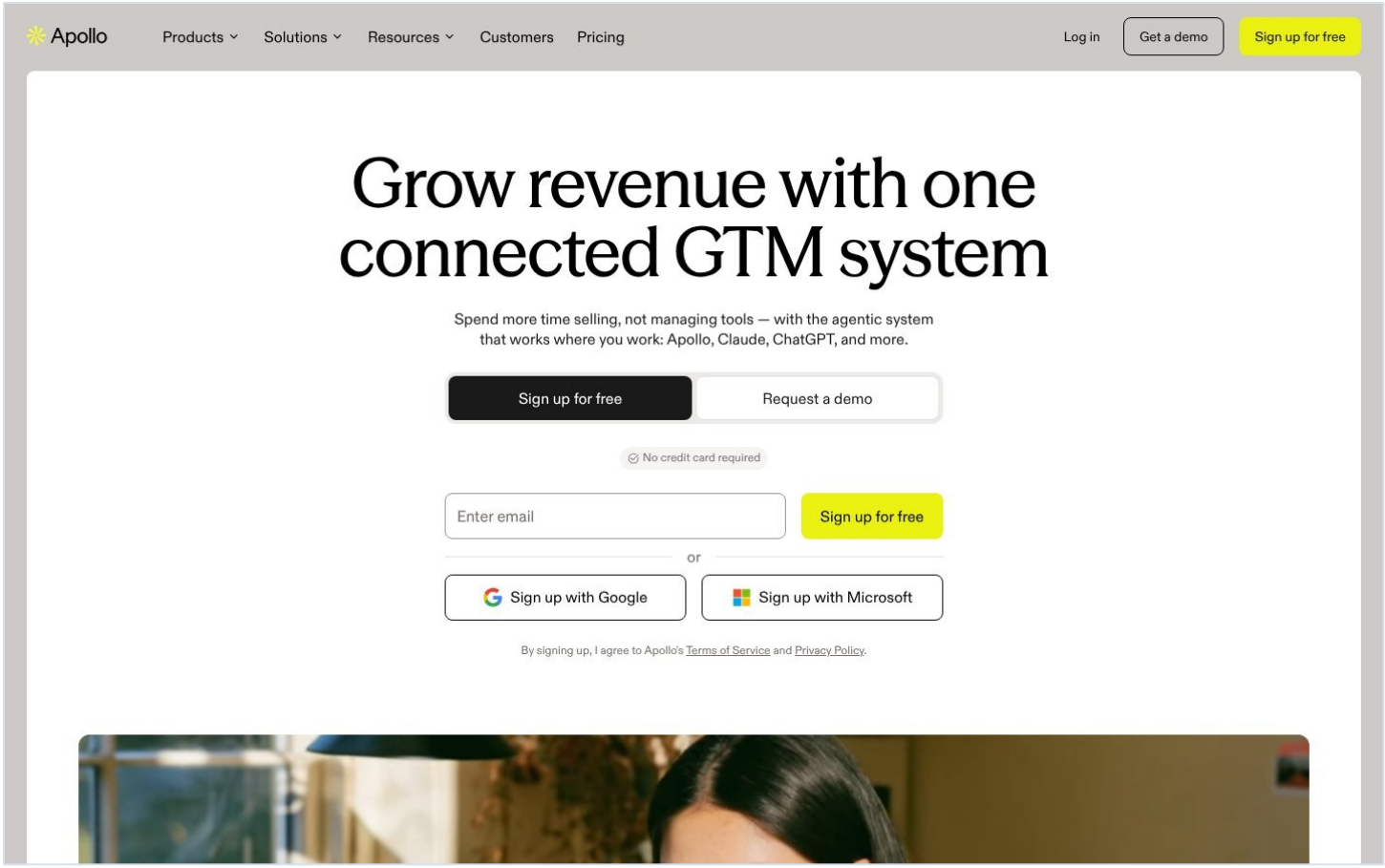
04

Email law built in

CAN-SPAM, GDPR, CASL and the platforms' own terms.

Apollo already works where Claude works

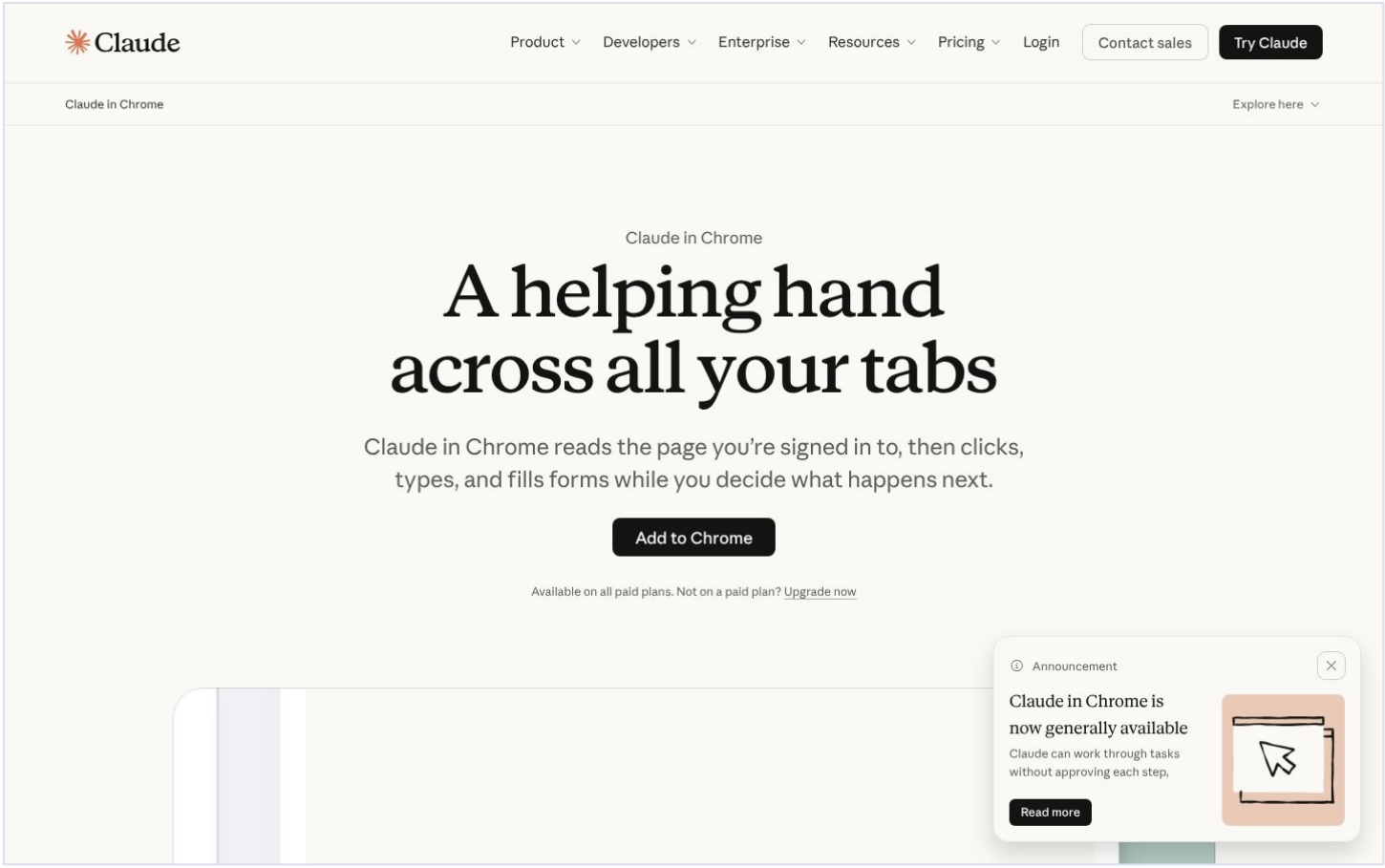
- Lists, enrichment and sequences without leaving the chat
- Connect it through Apollo's Claude integration or Composio
- Your ICP decides who goes on the list



APOLLO, APOLLO.IO. NOVEMBER 2026

No connector? Claude uses the browser

- Claude in Chrome reads the page, clicks, types and fills forms
- It works in the tools you're already signed in to
- You decide what happens next. Sending stays with you



CLAUDE IN CHROME, CLAUDE.COM. NOVEMBER 2026

Outreach with Claude driving and you approving

01

Signals

Prospector ranks who has a reason to talk this week.

02

Qualify

Sourced brief per account, from connectors and Apollo.

03

Draft

Your voice skill writes three short emails per person.

04

You send

Read the first send to each person. Then let it run.

The same email, before and after the brief

BEFORE, FROM A COLD TEMPLATE

Hi Sarah, I hope this finds you well. I'm reaching out because [company] helps organizations like yours unlock value with [product]. Leading companies trust us to drive outcomes. I'd love to find 30 minutes to share how we can help Acme accelerate its journey. Are you free next week?

AFTER, FROM THE BRIEF AND THE VOICE FILE

Sarah, your team posted four platform roles last month, which usually means the Kubernetes footprint just got bigger than one person can watch. What are you trying to fix first with it?

Happy to point you at the right docs, or 20 minutes if talking is easier. If it's not on your radar, say so and I'll stop.

Nothing goes out that you didn't read. Not because the AI is bad. Because it's your name.

08

Before, during and after the call

Prep in five minutes, listen instead of typing, follow up before lunch.

Five minutes before, nothing during, ten minutes after

01

Before

From the brief: five discovery questions, the two objections you'll hear, who's in the room and what each one cares about.

02

During

Recorder on, with consent. You look at the person, not the keyboard. Your notes are three words and a star.

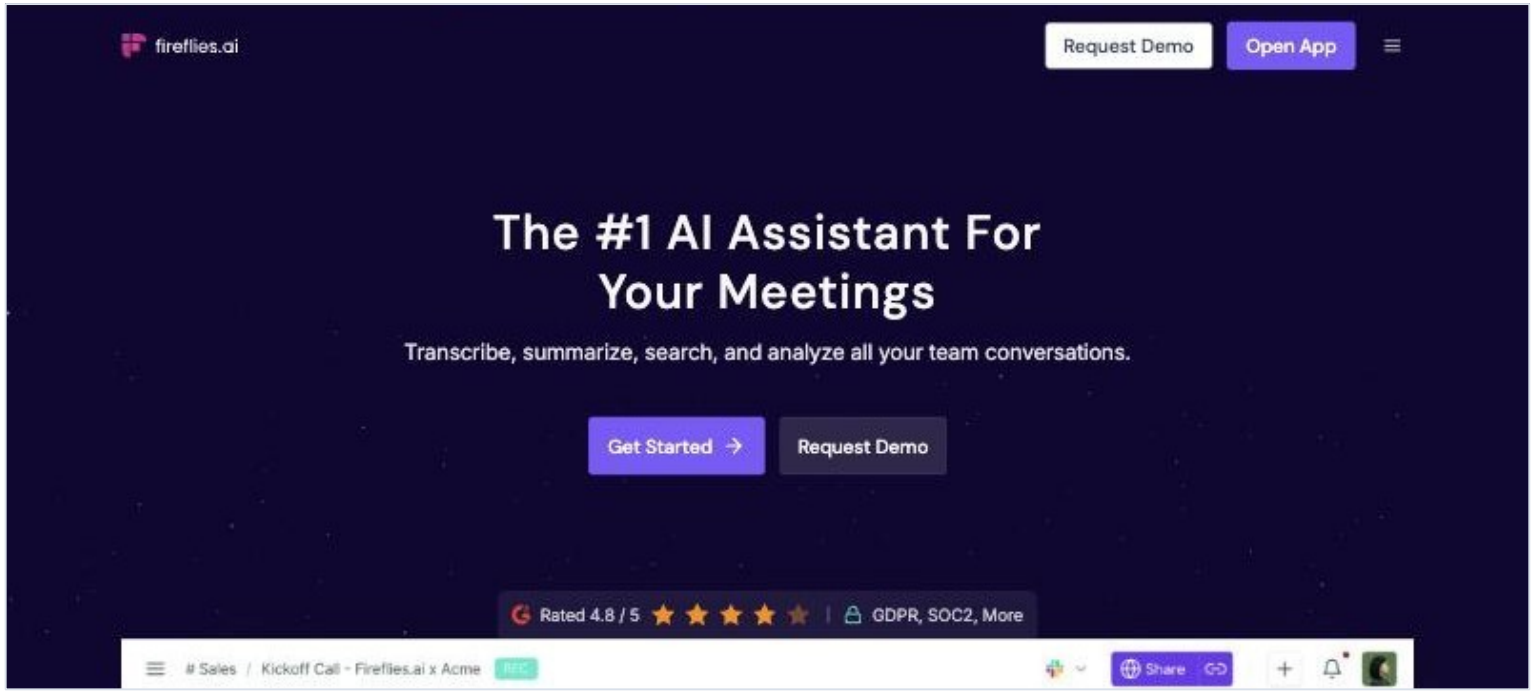
03

After

Transcript in, out comes the summary, the follow-up email in your voice, the CRM notes, the tasks with dates.

The recorder is the only new tool most of you need

- Zoom's AI Companion or a recorder like Fireflies: it joins the call, you get the transcript
- Ask for consent at the top of every call, every time
- The transcript goes into the company-approved assistant, never a free one



FIREFLIES.AI, ONE OF THE MEETING RECORDERS. NOVEMBER 2026

Follow up in ten minutes from the transcript

TYPE THIS, VERBATIM

```
Here's the transcript of my call with [Company]. [paste]
Produce four things: a 5-line summary in my words; a follow-up email in my voice that restates what
they said they need, confirms the next step and date, and asks nothing new; CRM notes under
"Pain, Timeline, Budget, Decision process, Competition, Next step"; and a task list with owners
and dates. Flag anything they said that contradicts our account brief.
```

09

The rules that keep you employed

Four of them. None are complicated.

Four rules

01

Some things never go in

Customer confidential data, personal data beyond a name and title, unreleased pricing or roadmap. Unless your company's tool is approved for it, it stays out.

02

Use the company seat

The team or business account has the retention and training settings your admin set. Your personal login doesn't.

03

Check before you trust

Names, numbers, dates, quotes. If you'd be embarrassed to be wrong about it, click the source.

04

It never sends

A working unsubscribe and your postal address on every sequence, by law. The assistant drafts. A person reads and sends.

At 99 percent accuracy, a thousand automated sends is ten mistakes with your signature on them.

Errors compound at machine speed. The human gate is the circuit breaker.

10

Your first week

One workflow, every day, for two weeks. Then add the next one.

Five days, one habit each

Day 1	**Build the three files**	Voice, ICP, product. Twenty minutes. Save them where your assistant loads them automatically.
Day 2	**Brief three accounts**	Ten minutes each. Click the links. Write the "why now" sentence for each.
Day 3	**Rewrite one sequence**	Three emails, under ninety words each, in your voice. Approve the first send yourself.
Day 4	**Record one call**	Prep sheet before, recorder on, follow-up and CRM notes sent inside ten minutes.
Day 5	**Review your toughest deal**	Run the skeptic prompt. Take the one action it names.

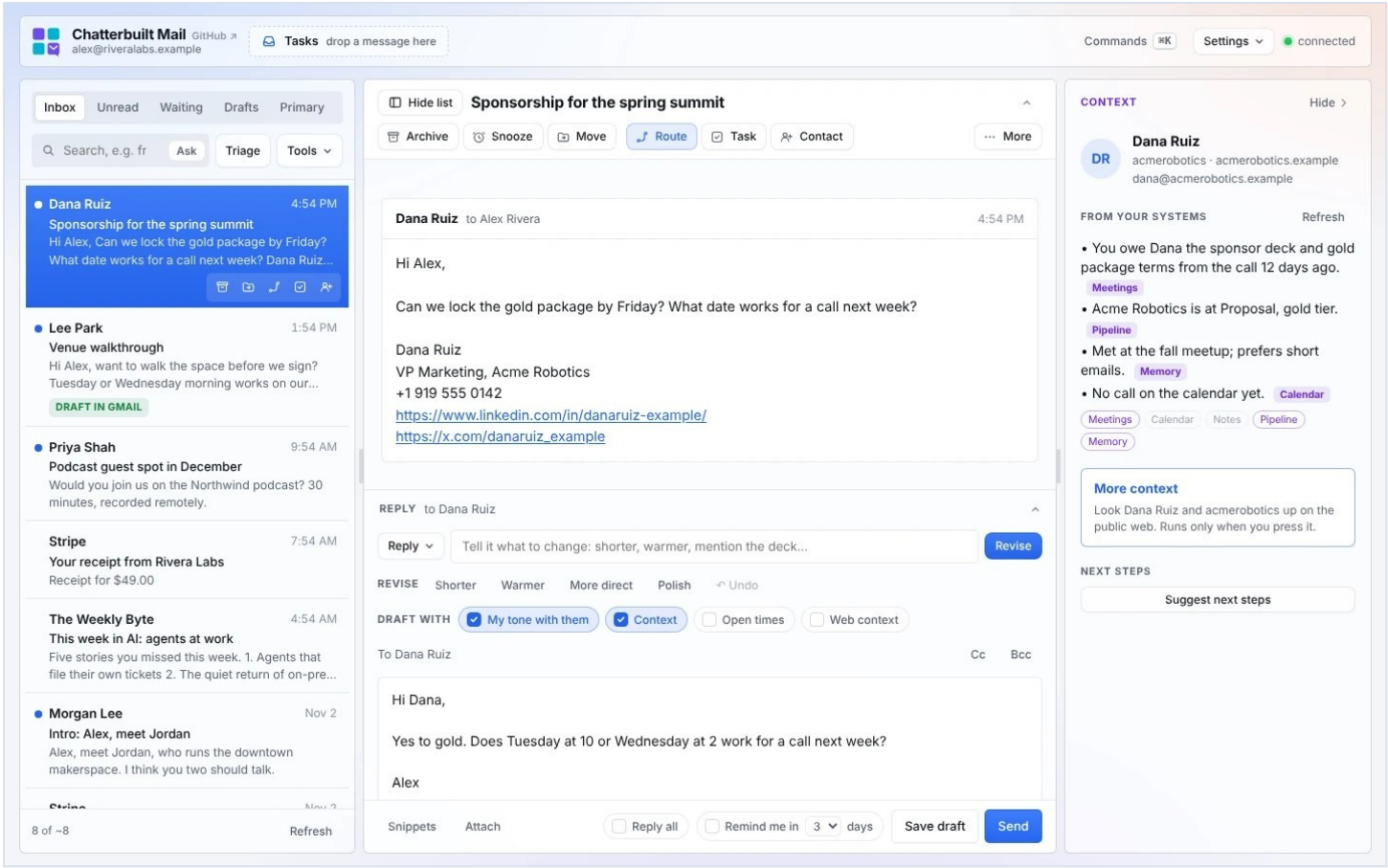
11

Put it all together: Chatterbuilt Mail

Connectors, skills and your voice, in one inbox.

Chatterbuilt Mail reads the room before you reply

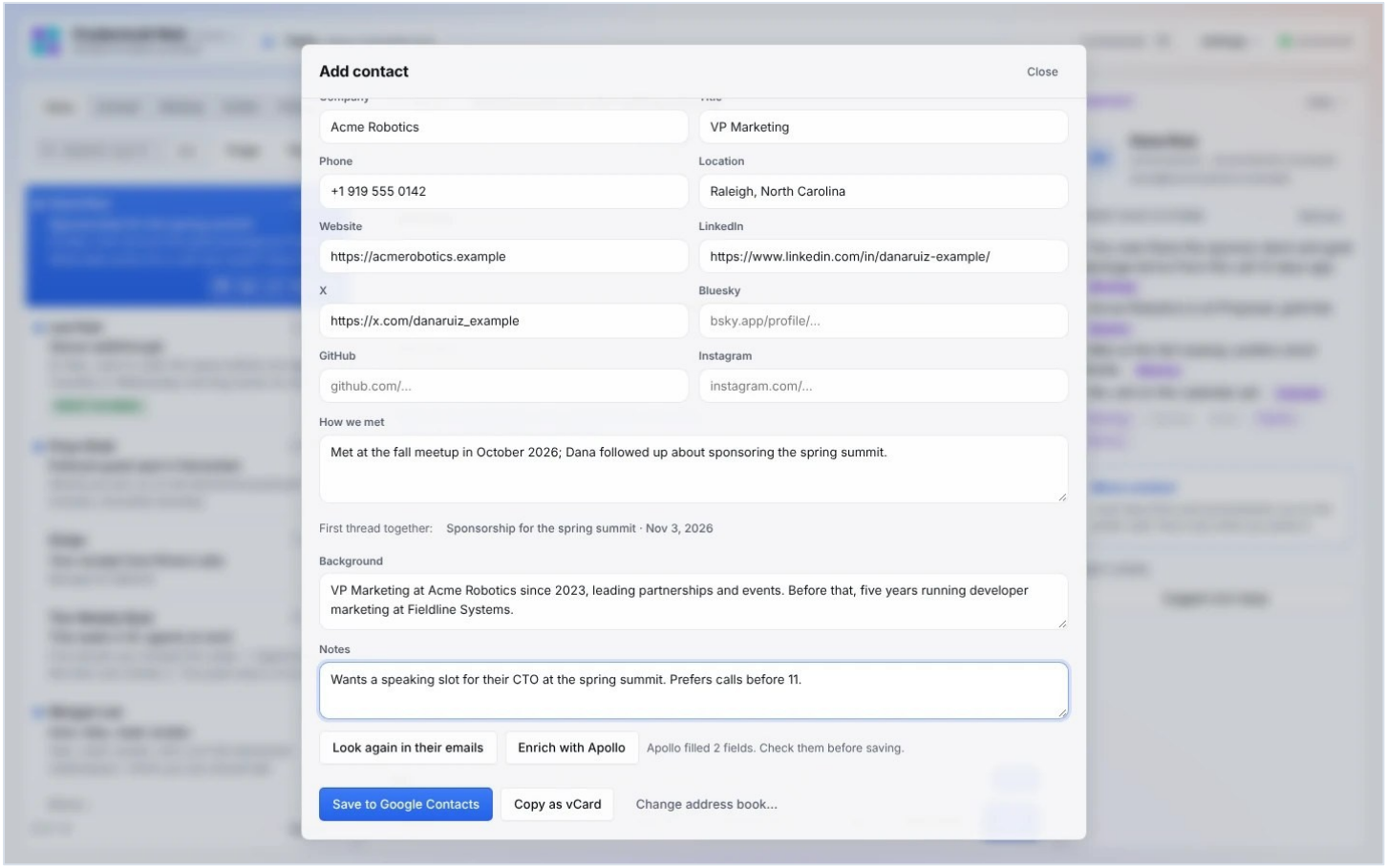
- Open a thread. It shows what your CRM, calendar and notes know
- Drafts in your voice, then checks it before you hit Send
- Nothing sends, moves or files until you click



CHATTERBUILT MAIL, THE PRE-SEND CHECK. MADE-UP DATA. NOVEMBER 2026

Every contact gets the whole picture

- How you met, from your first email together
- Title, company and history, enriched with Apollo or Clay
- Saved to your address book or your CRM after you check it



CHATTERBUILT MAIL, ADDING A CONTACT WITH APOLLO ENRICHMENT. MADE-UP DATA. NOVEMBER 2026

Watch it work my inbox.

Triage, a draft in my voice, the pre-send check. Nothing sends without me.

Everything from today lives in one place

The one rule, one more time: the AI drafts. You send.

The repository

github.com/mrhinkle/ai-for-sales-training

The deck, the speaker notes, every prompt you saw, and how to point your own assistant at it.

Questions after today

mrhinkle@peripety.com

Reply with the account you briefed and I'll read it.

The AIE Network

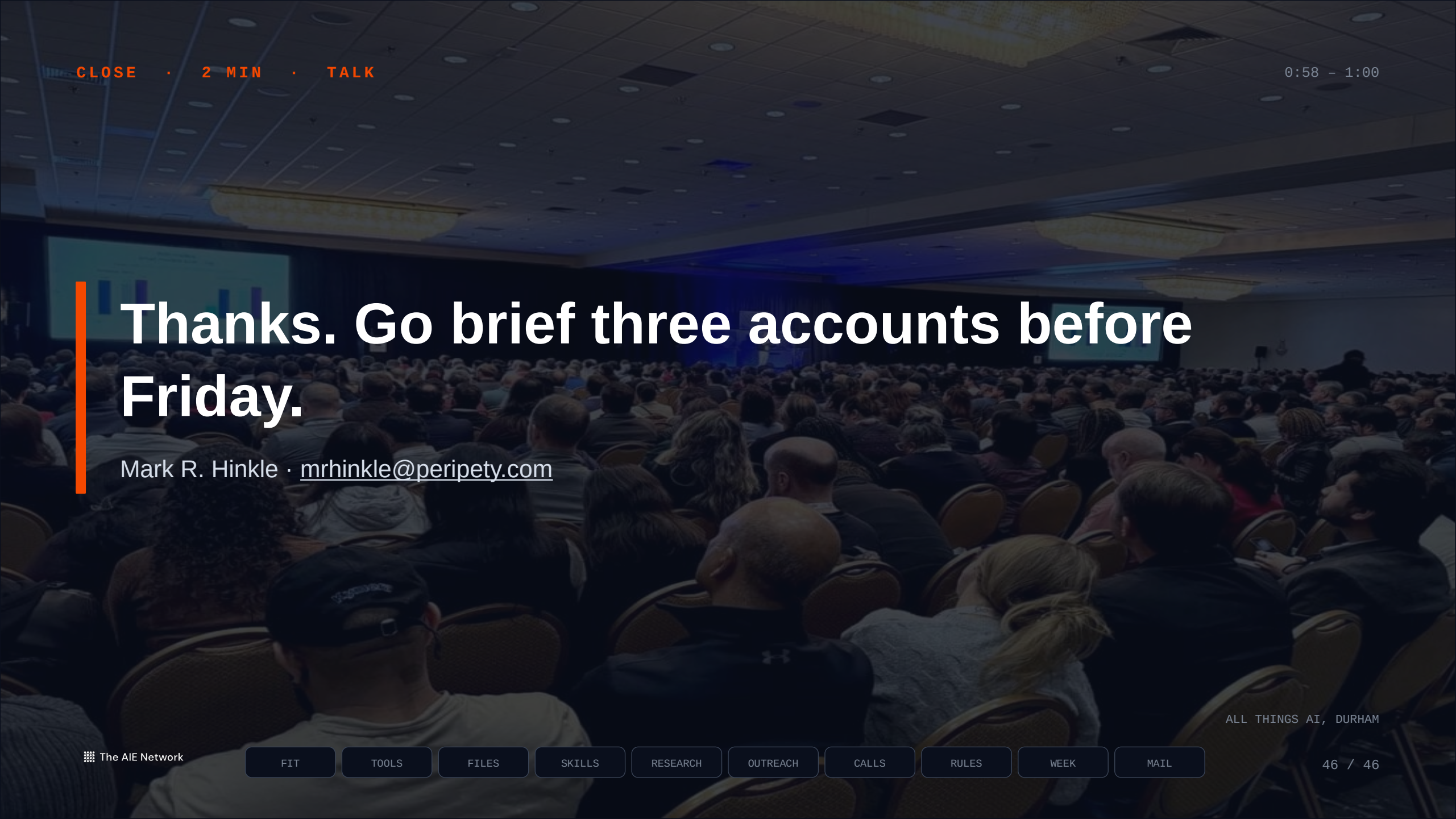
theaie.net

Seven newsletters, four mornings a week, on using AI at work.

All Things AI

allthingsai.org

The conference in Durham, April 18 to 20, 2027.



Thanks. Go brief three accounts before Friday.

Mark R. Hinkle · mrhinkle@peripety.com